Sling Inspection Checklist (29 CFR 1910.184)

Use before slings are used each day and whenever service conditions call for a further check during use.

OSHA 29 CFR 1910.184

DATE	SHIFT
INSPECTOR	AREA / EQUIPMENT ID

Before you start

1. Mark every item OK, Defect or N/A; mark a whole section N/A when it does not match the sling type.
2. If any item is marked Defect, remove the sling from service at once (1910.184(d)). Some findings mean permanent removal: chain heated above 1000 °F (1910.184(e)(6)), fiber core wire rope exposed to more than 200 °F (1910.184(f)(3)), and any defective fiber rope sling, since repaired fiber rope slings may not be used (1910.184(h)(6)).
3. The sling manufacturer's instructions and your site rules may add checks; 1910.184(c) lists further rigging practices, and metal mesh slings have their own removal conditions in 1910.184(g)(9).

Legal basis: 29 CFR 1910.184: Slings (Part 1910 Subpart N, Materials Handling and Storage) Source: eCFR, Title 29, text as of 2026-11-09
Online version and sources: https://safetyindex.blog/us/standards/1910-184-slings

SECTION A | All slings: inspection, markings and rigging

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
1	Pre-use inspection Ref. 1910.184(d)	A competent person designated by the employer checked the sling and all fastenings and attachments for damage or defects today, before first use	☐	☐	☐	
2	Identification marking Ref. 1910.184(c)(14)	Marking is affixed to the sling and can be read	☐	☐	☐	
3	Load against marked capacity Ref. 1910.184(c)(13)	Load to be lifted is no more than the manufacturer's recommended safe working load shown on the sling's markings	☐	☐	☐	
4	Overall condition Ref. 1910.184(c)(1)	No damage or defect of any kind is visible on the sling in use	☐	☐	☐	
5	Shortening Ref. 1910.184(c)(2)	Sling length not shortened with knots, bolts or other makeshift devices	☐	☐	☐	
6	Sling legs Ref. 1910.184(c)(3)	No kinks in any leg	☐	☐	☐	
7	Attachment to load Ref. 1910.184(c)(6)	Sling securely attached to the load before lifting	☐	☐	☐	
8	Sharp edges Ref. 1910.184(c)(7)	Padding or protection between the sling and every sharp edge of the load	☐	☐	☐	
9	People near the load Ref. 1910.184(c)(9)	Every employee is clear of the load before lift-off and while it is suspended	☐	☐	☐	
10	Shock loading Ref. 1910.184(c)(11)	No shock loading during the lift	☐	☐	☐	

SECTION B | Alloy steel chain slings

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
11	Identification tag Ref. 1910.184(e)(1)	Durable, permanently affixed tag states reach, size, grade and rated capacity	☐	☐	☐	

General guidance only, not legal advice. Check the current regulation and your employer's procedures.

SECTION B | Alloy steel chain slings

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
12	Thorough inspection interval Ref. 1910.184(e)(3)(i)	Thorough inspection done at the employer's set interval and no more than 12 months ago	☐	☐	☐	
13	Inspection record Ref. 1910.184(e)(3)(ii)	Record of the most recent month of thorough inspection exists for this sling and can be shown on request	☐	☐	☐	
14	Link wear Ref. 1910.184(e)(8)	No point on any link is below the minimum chain size in Table N-184-1	☐	☐	☐	
15	Master and coupling links Ref. 1910.184(e)(9)(i)	No cracked or deformed master links, coupling links or other components	☐	☐	☐	
16	Hooks Ref. 1910.184(e)(9)(ii)	Hook has no cracks, its throat at the narrowest spot has not opened over 15% beyond normal, and it is twisted no more than 10 degrees out of the unbent hook's plane	☐	☐	☐	
17	Links and fasteners Ref. 1910.184(e)(2)(ii)	No makeshift links or fasteners formed from bolts or rods	☐	☐	☐	
18	Heat exposure Ref. 1910.184(e)(6)	Chain has not been heated above 1000 °F	☐	☐	☐	

SECTION C | Wire rope slings

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
19	Marking Ref. 1910.184(f)(1)	Legible, permanently affixed manufacturer marking shows safe working load per hitch, the angle it is based on, and leg count on multi-leg slings	☐	☐	☐	
20	Broken wires Ref. 1910.184(f)(5)(i)	Fewer than ten randomly distributed broken wires in any rope lay, and fewer than five in any one strand of a lay	☐	☐	☐	
21	Outside wire wear Ref. 1910.184(f)(5)(ii)	Outside wires have not lost one-third of their original diameter to wear or scraping	☐	☐	☐	
22	Rope structure Ref. 1910.184(f)(5)(iii)	No kinking, crushing, bird caging or other distortion	☐	☐	☐	
23	Heat damage Ref. 1910.184(f)(5)(iv)	No evidence of heat damage on the rope	☐	☐	☐	
24	Fiber core heat exposure Ref. 1910.184(f)(3)	A fiber core rope has never been exposed to temperatures above 200 °F	☐	☐	☐	
25	End attachments Ref. 1910.184(f)(5)(v)	End attachments free of cracks, deformation and wear	☐	☐	☐	
26	Hooks Ref. 1910.184(f)(5)(vi)	Throat not opened past 15% of normal at its narrowest; twist within 10 degrees of the unbent position	☐	☐	☐	
27	Corrosion Ref. 1910.184(f)(5)(vii)	No corrosion on the rope or end attachments	☐	☐	☐	

SECTION D | Synthetic web slings

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
28	Web sling marking Ref. 1910.184(i)(1)	Marking or code shows hitch-by-hitch rated capacities and the web material	☐	☐	☐	

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SECTION D | Synthetic web slings						
No.	**Check item**	**What to look for**	**OK**	**Defect**	**N/A**	**Notes**
29	Webbing damage Ref. 1910.184(i)(9)(iii)	No snags, punctures, tears or cuts in the webbing	☐	☐	☐	
30	Chemical burns Ref. 1910.184(i)(9)(i)	No acid or caustic burns	☐	☐	☐	
31	Melting or charring Ref. 1910.184(i)(9)(ii)	No melting or charring anywhere on the sling surface	☐	☐	☐	
32	Stitching Ref. 1910.184(i)(9)(iv)	No broken or worn stitches	☐	☐	☐	
33	Web sling fittings Ref. 1910.184(i)(9)(v)	Fittings show no distortion	☐	☐	☐	
34	Nylon and acids Ref. 1910.184(i)(6)(i)	A nylon sling is not used where acids or phenolics are present as fume, vapor, spray, mist or liquid	☐	☐	☐	
35	Polyester or polypropylene and caustics Ref. 1910.184(i)(6)(ii)	A polyester or polypropylene sling is not used where caustics are present as fume, vapor, spray, mist or liquid	☐	☐	☐	
36	Aluminum fittings and caustics Ref. 1910.184(i)(6)(iii)	A web sling with aluminum fittings is kept away from caustics, whatever the form (fumes, mists, vapors, sprays or liquids)	☐	☐	☐	
37	Temperature Ref. 1910.184(i)(7)	A polyester or nylon sling is not used above 180 °F; a polypropylene sling is not used above 200 °F	☐	☐	☐	

SECTION E | Natural and synthetic fiber rope slings						
No.	**Check item**	**What to look for**	**OK**	**Defect**	**N/A**	**Notes**
38	Fiber rope marking Ref. 1910.184(h)(1)	Legible, permanently affixed marking shows rated capacity per hitch and its angle, the fiber type, and leg count on multi-leg slings	☐	☐	☐	
39	Abnormal wear Ref. 1910.184(h)(5)(i)	No abnormal wear on the rope	☐	☐	☐	
40	Powdered fiber Ref. 1910.184(h)(5)(ii)	No powdered fiber between strands	☐	☐	☐	
41	Broken or cut fibers Ref. 1910.184(h)(5)(iii)	No broken or cut fibers	☐	☐	☐	
42	Strand size and roundness Ref. 1910.184(h)(5)(iv)	No variations in the size or roundness of strands	☐	☐	☐	
43	Discoloration and rot Ref. 1910.184(h)(5)(v)	No discoloration or rotting	☐	☐	☐	
44	Sling hardware Ref. 1910.184(h)(5)(vi)	No distortion of hardware in the sling	☐	☐	☐	
45	New rope only Ref. 1910.184(h)(6)	Sling is made from new rope and has never been repaired or reconditioned	☐	☐	☐	
46	Temperature Ref. 1910.184(h)(2)	Used between minus 20 °F and plus 180 °F, or as its manufacturer recommends when outside that range or wet frozen	☐	☐	☐	

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DEFECTS FOUND AND ACTION TAKEN

Item no.	Defect description	Reported to	Action taken / date closed

SIGN-OFF

SAFE TO OPERATE?	☐ Yes ☐ No: tagged out of service	
INSPECTOR SIGNATURE		DATE / TIME
SUPERVISOR REVIEW		DATE / TIME